

Why do wasps sting?

Only female wasps and only some species of wasp can sting. Social wasps (which live in groups) may sting to defend themselves or their nests if they are in danger. Solitary wasps (which live alone) also use their sting to kill or stun their prey.

A sting in the tail.....

A wasp's sting injects venom (poison) into its prey. Wasps can curl the back part of their bodies under and forward to use the sting.

Insect defense

Not all insects have a sting to defend themselves. Assassin bugs can spit venom (poison) at an attacker from up to 1 ft (30 cm) away. They also kill prey by biting it and injecting it with venom. Sometimes they work as a team to overpower prey much bigger than themselves.

Assassin bug



Warning stripes.....

These black and yellow stripes warn other animals that the wasp is dangerous.

• Barbs and claws

Wasps have sharp barbs on their legs. At the end of their legs, claws help them to grip and carry prey.

